

RISING BEYOND BORDERS

Document 16 — Accessibility & Inclusive UX
Master Specification + Claude Code Implementation Prompt

Status: Implementation specification

Purpose: Establish the production accessibility and inclusive-UX standard for the RBB website. This phase formalizes accessibility behavior already present in the implementation and adds a repeatable acceptance standard without redesigning previously approved pages.

1. Accessibility Objective

Rising Beyond Borders should be usable by people with different abilities, input methods, screen sizes and interaction preferences. Accessibility is a product requirement, not a final visual QA step. New components and content must preserve the same standard.

Target: WCAG 2.2 Level AA as the engineering target. This is a project target and must not be presented publicly as certification or legal compliance unless RBB separately approves that wording.

2. Non-Negotiable Principles

- Every important interaction must be operable by keyboard.
- Visible focus must never be removed without an accessible replacement.
- Meaningful content must remain available without JavaScript, consistent with Document 15.
- Prefer native semantic HTML over ARIA when native HTML expresses the behavior.
- ARIA must describe actual behavior.
- Color must not be the only carrier of meaning.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion.
- Form errors and status changes must be understandable to screen-reader and keyboard users.
- Touch interactions need adequate size and spacing.
- Accessibility fixes must not introduce horizontal overflow.

3. Semantic Structure

- Use one meaningful page-level h1 per page.
- Heading levels represent structure, not visual size.
- Use header, nav, main, section, article, aside and footer where appropriate.
- Use list semantics for collections and navigation.
- Use native buttons for actions and links for navigation.
- Do not create clickable divs/spans where native controls are appropriate.

4. Skip Navigation & Landmarks

- Provide a keyboard-accessible skip link to main content.
- Make the skip link visible when focused.
- Ensure the target is stable.

- Keep header, primary navigation, main and footer structurally identifiable.
- Mobile navigation must expose expanded/collapsed state.

5. Keyboard & Focus

- All interactive controls must be keyboard reachable.
- Tab order follows logical reading order.
- Do not use positive tabindex values.
- Every focus stop needs a visible indicator.
- Do not trap focus in ordinary page components.
- Menus/dialogs need deliberate focus behavior.
- Return focus to a trigger after closing a temporary overlay when appropriate.
- Do not make essential information hover-only.

6. Navigation & Menus

- Desktop dropdowns must be keyboard accessible.
- Escape should close open menus where appropriate.
- Menu state must be communicated to assistive technology.
- Mobile navigation needs an accessible name and expanded/collapsed state.
- Current-page indication should be programmatically determinable where applicable.
- Avoid hover-only disclosure.

7. Links & Buttons

- Link text should communicate its destination.
- Avoid generic repeated labels such as Click here.
- Buttons perform actions; links navigate.
- Icon-only controls require an accessible name.
- Disabled controls must communicate state.
- External links should be understandable from context.

8. Images & Alternative Text

- Meaningful images need useful alt text.
- Decorative images should use empty alt.
- Do not unnecessarily duplicate nearby visible text.
- Never use filenames as alt text.
- Preserve Document 15 image sizing and responsive behavior.
- Optimization must not remove meaningful information.

9. Color & Contrast

Approved visual identity: Deep Trust Blue #10437C; Bright Sky Blue #00ADEF; Light Gray #F5F7FA; White #FFFFFF; Charcoal #3A3A3A; Growth Green #5CB85C.

- Check contrast in actual text/control contexts.
- Do not silently redesign the brand palette.
- If a combination fails in a context, use an accessible approved treatment such as weight, size, background, border or another approved pairing.
- Never communicate status through color alone.

10. Typography & Zoom

- Preserve Satoshi with Arial fallback unless RBB approves a brand change.
- Text remains readable when browser text size increases.
- Avoid fixed text heights that clip content.
- Long headings must wrap safely.
- Do not disable browser zoom.

11. Responsive & Touch UX

- Test 320px through desktop widths.
- No ordinary content should require horizontal scrolling.
- Interactive targets need adequate size and spacing.
- Essential controls must not be too close together.
- Mobile forms must work with software keyboards.

12. Motion & Animation

- Respect prefers-reduced-motion.
- Reduced motion should remove/reduce non-essential movement without hiding content.
- Do not rely on animation for essential state.
- Avoid rapidly flashing content.
- Scroll reveals must not hide meaningful content when JavaScript fails.

13. Forms & Validation

- Every field has an associated label.
- Required fields are programmatically identifiable.
- Instructions appear before they are needed.
- Errors identify the field and explain the correction.
- Error summaries, where used, are keyboard reachable.
- Inline errors are associated with fields.
- Never use placeholder text as the label.
- Dynamic success/sending/error states are accessible.
- Disabled forms clearly communicate their state.

- Do not collect unnecessary personal information.

14. Status, Loading & Error States

- Loading states must not trap focus.
- Dynamic status changes should be exposed where appropriate.
- Errors must not expose technical details.
- The Document 15 'Something went wrong' wording remains proposed pending RBB approval.
- 404 pages provide clear explanation and useful navigation.
- Optional service failures must not make unrelated content inaccessible.

15. Tables, Metrics & Data

- Use actual table semantics for tabular data.
- Tables need meaningful headers and relationships.
- Impact metrics remain understandable without visual styling.
- Financial 78/12/10 has text equivalents; graphical bars cannot be the only representation.
- Visualizations need accessible textual interpretations.
- Do not add a chart library unless it supports the required accessible experience.

16. Content Accessibility

- Use clear language where practical.
- Do not put essential information only in images.
- Avoid unexplained abbreviations in important content.
- Use meaningful link text.
- Content authors provide useful alt text and headings.
- Pending content must not pretend to contain information RBB has not supplied.

17. Shared Component Acceptance

Component	Required checks
Header/navigation	Keyboard, focus, expanded state, current location
Buttons/links	Native semantics, accessible name, focus
Forms	Labels, required state, errors, status
Cards	Heading hierarchy, link/action semantics
Images	Alt strategy, sizing, decorative treatment
Modal/overlay	Focus management, Escape, accessible name
Footer	Landmark, links, contrast
Error boundary	Readable message, recovery navigation, no leak

18. Automated Accessibility Testing

- Run accessibility checks against production builds.
- Use automated checks for names, ARIA, contrast where detectable, duplicate IDs and landmarks.
- Automated testing is a safety net, not proof of accessibility.
- Keep existing route, responsive and console checks.
- Test representative pages from every major template.

19. Manual Accessibility Testing

- Keyboard-only pass.
- Visible-focus pass.
- Screen-reader pass where available.
- Zoom/text-resize pass.
- Reduced-motion pass.
- Mobile touch pass.
- Form error/success pass.
- 404 and runtime-error pass.
- Check pre-rendered HTML and hydrated behavior.
- Verify no meaningful content disappears with JavaScript disabled.

20. Representative Acceptance Routes

- Home — navigation, hero, metrics, cards, CTAs.
- About — headings, values/team placeholders, transparency links.
- Work — program cards and project empty state.
- Impact — metrics and visual/data information.
- Get Involved — path cards and pending interaction states.
- Donate — pending donation state.
- Contact — pending contact/form state.
- Transparency — financial percentages and jump links.
- Stories — empty state.
- 404 — recovery navigation.

21. Accessibility Statement Dependency

The /accessibility page remains pending until RBB provides and reviews public accessibility information. This specification must not automatically become a public legal/compliance statement. WCAG 2.2 AA is the engineering target.

22. Claude Code Implementation Prompt

You are implementing Document 16 – Accessibility & Inclusive UX for the Rising Beyond Borders website.

CONTEXT

- Documents 01-15 are implemented and approved.
- Document 15 introduced build-time pre-rendering and verified JavaScript-off behavior.
- Do not redesign approved pages.
- Do not invent RBB content, legal claims or accessibility certifications.
- Do not stage or commit changes.

GOAL

Audit and strengthen the implementation against WCAG 2.2 Level AA as an engineering target while preserving the existing design system, content architecture, routes and rendering architecture.

CHECK

1. Semantic HTML: meaningful h1/h2/h3 hierarchy, landmarks, native controls, real lists/tables.
2. Skip link: visible on focus and reaches main content.
3. Keyboard: all interactions reachable; no positive tabindex; logical order; visible focus.
4. Navigation: desktop dropdowns and mobile menu work by keyboard; states exposed; Escape works where appropriate.
5. Links/buttons: accessible names, native semantics, no unnecessary ARIA.
6. Images: meaningful alt, decorative empty alt, no filename alt, preserve responsive sizing.
7. Color: check actual contrast contexts; do not silently redesign brand palette; no color-only meaning.
8. Typography: preserve Satoshi/Arial; verify zoom/text resize and wrapping.
9. Responsive/touch: test 320px through desktop; no overflow; adequate targets; mobile keyboard usability.
10. Motion: preserve prefers-reduced-motion; scroll reveal must not hide content without JS.
11. Forms: labels, required state, associated errors, accessible dynamic states; forms remain disabled until approved.
12. Errors: no technical leakage; verify ErrorBoundary and 404; keep proposed wording pending approval.
13. Data: financial 78/12/10 and metrics have text equivalents; tables have headers; future charts need accessible text.
14. Content: clear language, meaningful links, no essential info only in images.

TEST

- production build
- automated accessibility scan
- keyboard-only
- focus-visible
- mobile navigation
- reduced-motion
- zoom/text resize
- representative screen-reader checks
- JavaScript-off
- 320-1440px
- console errors
- routes/404

ROUTES

Home, About, Work, one program, Impact, Get Involved, Donate, Contact, Transparency, Stories and 404.

REPORT

Return issues found, fixes, files/components changed, automated/manual results, routes tested, remaining issues and RBB approvals required.

Do not claim WCAG certification. Do not stage or commit.

23. Acceptance Checklist

- ✓ WCAG 2.2 AA is an engineering target, not a certification claim.
- ✓ Keyboard navigation works.
- ✓ Focus indicators remain visible.
- ✓ Skip navigation works.
- ✓ Navigation states are accessible.
- ✓ Forms and pending states are accessible.
- ✓ Images have deliberate alt treatment.
- ✓ Color is not the sole carrier of meaning.
- ✓ Zoom/text resize does not break layout.
- ✓ Reduced motion is respected.

- ✓ 320–1440px layouts have no horizontal overflow.
- ✓ Metrics and financial information have non-visual equivalents.
- ✓ Error and 404 states are accessible.
- ✓ JavaScript-off preserves meaningful content.
- ✓ Automated and manual checks are documented.
- ✓ No public accessibility certification/legal claim is added without RBB approval.

RBB decisions still required: final public accessibility statement, accessibility-specific legal language, final error-page wording, and approval of any brand-color treatment introduced for contrast.